

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8a-q8dm-chb8
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-2799

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Name: Steven Swanson

General Comment

Excluding companies that utilize AI from copyright law will bring about the death of the trillion-dollar entertainment industry in the United States, taking along with it much of the professional class.

Make no mistake. Writers, artists, photographers, filmmakers, musicians, designers, architects, engineers, software developers, all make use of technology to enhance their craft, but until now each new tool has not infringed upon the basic ownership that these creators have over their creations.

We already have clear evidence that generative AI takes enormous amounts of copyrighted materials without the consent of their owners and uses them to train and refine AI models, often with the express objective of depriving the aforementioned copyright owners of their livelihoods.

It is disturbingly easy to achieve. An AI can take a fraction of an artist's body of work, work that frequently has taken a lifetime to perfect and distinguish, and then begin producing unauthorized likenesses of their work within minutes, flooding galleries and image searches with counterfeits and misrepresentations, drowning the creator in a procedurally generated flood of slop.

What does this ultimately mean? In no small terms, the evisceration of art and entertainment. Creators will continue to create, but if they believe that sharing their work online will result in wholesale theft then they will have no incentive to do so. Those that survive will find their way to ply their trade outside the U.S. economy, with the most straightforward method being to relocate to a country that does protect their intellectual property. Our loss will be their gain.

While the creators vanish, consumers will be inundated with derivative, inauthentic slop produced in quantities too vast to be adequately inspected or regulated, and consumers will lose faith in the ability of media to inform, inspire, and entertain. All you have to do is conduct a Google image search to see just how pervasive the problem already is, with up to 90% of results being A.I. generated derivatives that distort and destroy public trust. AI is even being used to quickly create spoof websites of news sites, retailers, financial services, and even emergency services, stealing citizens' sensitive information and money while giving nothing of value in return.

As it stands, companies invested in AI do not have a credible best use case for this technology, with most investing in it based on a fear of missing out on the Next Big Thing. No one in tech company boardrooms is discussing the damage AI can do, and that is exactly why the U.S. Government should not entertain the utopian propaganda of AI's advocates.

I have very little faith that this government will make a decision to protect the long-term health of the nation, including that of the unaccountable oligarchs that now hold it in a stranglehold, but on this issue I felt a need to make my voice heard.

Exempting AI tech companies from copyright will kill people. Worse than that it will kill any trust in authority, and risks crushing our nation's soul.